W.S.84. **The solar system.** Name .....

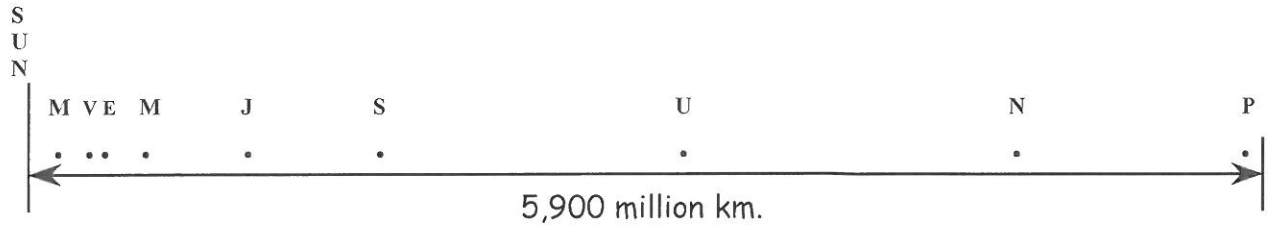
The Sun and other stars are sources of light. Planets orbit stars and do not make their own light. We can sometimes see the moon and some of the planets at night because they REFLECT light from the Sun. The SOLAR SYSTEM is our Sun together with the nine planets that orbit it. The order of the nine planets starting with the one closest to the Sun is :

Mercury Venus Earth Mars Jupiter Saturn Uranus Neptune Pluto

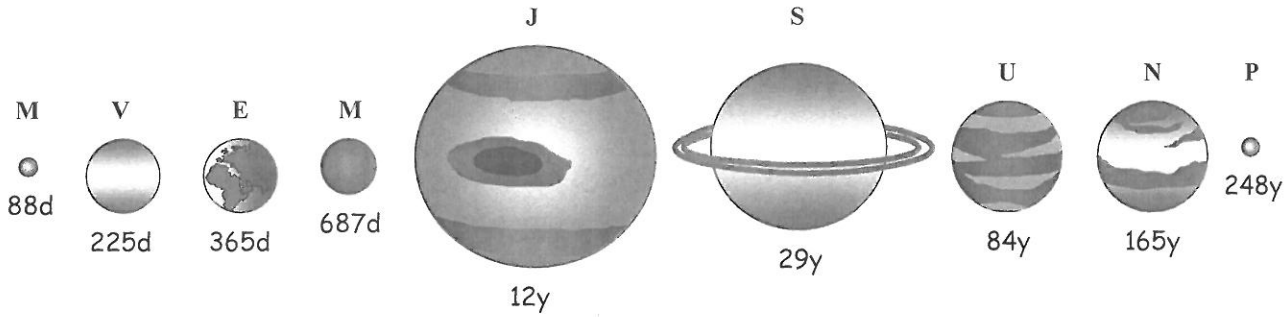
An easy way to remember the order of the planets is to remember this rhyme :

My Very Easy Method Just Speeds Up Naming Planets.

The diagram below gives an idea of how far the planets are from the Sun.



The diagram below shows how the planets compare in size. The length of each planet's year (orbit time) is also given underneath each one (d = days, y = years.)



THE FURTHER THE PLANET IS FROM THE SUN THE LONGER IT TAKES TO ORBIT.

Exercise - Complete the sentences below.

1) The planet that is closest to Earth is _ _ _ _ _

2) The largest planet is _ _ _ _ _ _ _

3) The further the planet is from the Sun the _ _ _ _ _ _ is its year.

4) The planet with a year about twice as long as Earth's is _ _ _ _

5) Planets that are close to the Sun have very _ _ _ _ temperatures.

6) The rings around _ _ _ _ _ _ are easily seen.

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